

The Biogas Maverick: How one Founder Cracked India's \$15 Billion Clean Energy Code in 24 Months

Most entrepreneurs spend years building credibility. Utkarsh Gupta spent two years building an empire—63 CBG biogas plants in pipeline, \$480 million in projects, and a German engineering subsidiary that's rewriting the rules of India's energy transition.

February 2023. A cramped office in Noida. Four people. One audacious idea: transform India's mountains of agricultural waste into the nation's fuel independence while making farmers wealthy in the process.

Fast forward 24 months. Gruner Renewable Energy is on a steep upward trajectory across India's biogas landscape, moving with a velocity that makes venture capitalists alert and competitors recalibrate. The numbers point to what's coming next: 63 CBG plants in the pipeline, a projected avoidance of over 250 million tonnes of CO₂ emissions as these plants come online, 20,000 jobs set to be created, and a growth curve that tracks decisively toward a \$15 billion valuation by 2030. This isn't a story of what has already been achieved—it's a blueprint of what is being built at scale.

Utkarsh Gupta, a finance and execution specialist turned clean energy disruptor, didn't just enter a market. He reconstructed it entirely.

"At Gruner, sustainability isn't just a goal. It is the foundation of everything we do," Gupta declares. But the real story isn't what he says. It's what he's built.

Now consider Kisan's intervention in the feedstock economy. While the biogas sector long grappled with fragmented and unreliable agricultural waste supply, Gupta approached the problem at its root—by digitizing the entire agri-residue value chain. The Kisan platform connects more than 20,000 farmers directly with CBG plants, removing middlemen, standardizing pricing, and converting informal, opaque transactions into a transparent digital marketplace. Complementing this, the Kisan Didi initiative repositions rural women as Agri-tech operators, equipped with smartphones, data-driven insights, and direct access to income, embedding technology, trust, and economic agency deep within the rural ecosystem.

"Kisan is more than just a platform. It's a movement to restore dignity to the farmer," explains Damini Bisht, Co-Founder of Kisan Urja.

But Gupta's masterstroke arrived in 2025. While competitors debated domestic



UTKARSH GUPTA
Founder and CEO, Gruner Renewable Energy

expansion, he established Gruner New Energie Deutschland GmbH in Osnabrück, Germany, not as symbolic presence but as operational nerve center. The German entity now drives technology innovation, develops AI-powered SaaS platforms for plant optimization, and engineer's solutions blending European precision with Indian scale.

"With experience building over 500+ biogas plants globally, I see tremendous potential in India's renewable energy landscape," observes Mehmet Oenal, COO of Gruner New Energie Deutschland GmbH.

The infrastructure play is what separates Gruner from conventional EPC firms. Instead of outsourcing execution, Gupta launched Gruner Infra, a dedicated civil engineering arm that self-executes every critical structural component—from plant foundations to core on-site infrastructure. This deep vertical integration removes third-party dependencies, compresses decision cycles, and keeps quality and timelines under direct control, enabling project delivery at speeds rarely seen in the sector.

Each Gruner plant is on the path to becoming a living, learning machine, a cyber-physical ecosystem where IoT sensors stream real-time intelligence, AI models begin to anticipate failures before they surface, and digital twins steadily refine feedstock-to-energy conversion. Systems don't just operate; they learn,

adapt, and improve with every cycle. Downtime is increasingly predicted, efficiency compounds over time, and decisions shift from instinct to algorithms. This isn't biogas as it has been known. This is biogas evolving toward its future, shaped by Silicon Valley execution discipline and built to scale a decarbonized world.

The scope expands beyond present capacity. Gruner's roadmap targets 500+ biogas plants, entry into green hydrogen and sustainable aviation fuel production, plus comprehensive renewable energy portfolio spanning solar and wind.

BUILDING FOR LONGEVITY

As sustainability moves from intent to impact, scale and governance become decisive. Gruner's expansion strategy focuses on strengthening manufacturing capabilities, investing in digital monitoring, and building leadership depth across engineering and operations.

"Our roots may be Indian, but our vision is truly global," Gupta emphasizes. "We're not just building projects. We're building a model for the world to follow."

Gruner's journey underscores a broader lesson for India's transition. The most powerful climate solutions may not always be the most visible. Distributed, rural-first systems, executed with discipline, can deliver both environmental and economic outcomes.

As India advances toward its net-zero commitments, companies like Gruner represent a new generation of change makers, those who see sustainability not as an auxiliary agenda, but as a core economic strategy.

Frugality. Agility. Purpose-led growth. These weren't just founding principles for Gruner. They became competitive weapons delivering what India's renewable energy sector desperately needed: execution velocity married to technological excellence, wrapped in genuine social impact.

Sometimes revolution doesn't require decades. Sometimes it just requires someone crazy enough to execute at impossible speed.